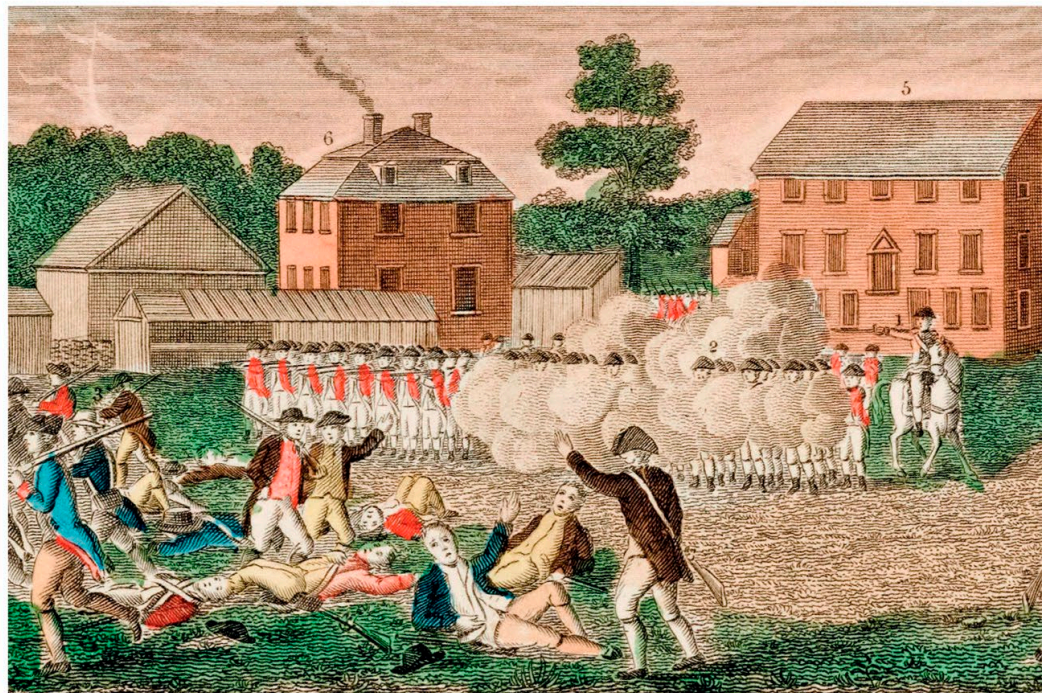


1775

AMERICAN REVOLUTIONARY WAR BEGINS

As discontent in America grew, the British began to fear an armed rebellion. On 19 April, General Thomas Gage led a group of British soldiers to seize guns and ammunition being held by American “patriots”. Rebel militia clashed with the British at Lexington and Concord, and fighting soon spread throughout New England. George Washington was appointed commander-in-chief of the revolutionary Continental Army, leading it until the war for independence ended in 1783.

▽ **Battle of Lexington**, the first engagement of the American Revolutionary War



1775

1775 The First Anglo-Maratha War breaks out in India



1775

DEATH OF FUKUDA CHIYO-NI (KAGA NO CHIYO)

One of Japan's greatest haiku poets, Fukuda Chiyo-ni was a scroll-mounter's daughter from Kaga Province. She began writing at the age of seven and developed her own style after studying the poems of Matsuo Bashō. She became a Buddhist nun in 1754, taking the name Soen.

◁ **Lady Chiyo**, woodblock print



△ **Liberty Bell**, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

1776

AMERICA DECLARES INDEPENDENCE

On 4 July 1776, Congress adopted the Declaration of Independence, celebrating the “self-evident truths” of the rights to life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness, denouncing King George III as a “tyrant”, and dissolving “all political connection” between Britain and its American colonies. Bells, including the Liberty Bell (above), rang to announce the news.